Webinar on "Soft Skills Significance for a Software Professional" 2020

On 22nd May 2020, Friday. The webinar was delivered by Dr. Mandeep Walia, Delivery Manager, Infosys and Department Alumni with association with Department of Computer Science & Applications, Panjab University.

About the event:

A webinar dated 22nd May 2020 with mentor Dr. Mandeep Walia, Delivery Manager Infosys was held on the topic "Soft skills significance for a software professional". In total 118 students from the department attended the online workshop.

The session was commenced with the introduction the soft skills and demonstrated a soft skill umbrella that included:

- Professional Ethics
- Business Acumen
- Organizational Skills
- Flexibility
- Constraint follow through
- Confidence & Self Esteem
- Dressing up well
- Knowledge Sharing
- Teaching Mentoring
- Leadership
- Analytical & Critical Thinking
- Teamwork
- Positive Attitude

The umbrella was explained by introducing every element. A glimpse was given and the importance of each element was explained by quoting real life examples.

The speaker explained the following:

1. Soft skills are a combination of people skills, social skills, communication skills, character or personality traits, attitudes, career attributes, social intelligence and emotional intelligence quotients, among others, that enable people to navigate their environment, work well with others, perform well, and achieve their goals with complementing hard skills.
2. Soft skills are a cluster of productive personality traits that characterize one's relationships in a milieu. These skills can include social graces, communication abilities, language skills, personal habits, cognitive or emotional empathy, time management, teamwork and leadership traits. A definition based on review literature explains soft skills as an umbrella term for

skills under three key functional elements: people skills, social skills, and personal career attributes.

3. Following is a "top ten" list of soft skills employers are looking for in college students and new workers:

1. Communication – oral speaking capability, written, presenting, listening, clear speech & writing.
2. Courtesy – manners, etiquette, business etiquette, gracious, says please and thank you, respectful.
3. Flexibility – adaptability, willing to change, lifelong learner, accepts new things, adjusts, teachable.
4. Integrity – honest, ethical, high morals, has personal values, does what's right.
5. Interpersonal skills – nice, personable, sense of humor, friendly, nurturing, empathetic, has self-control, patient, sociability, warmth, social skills.
6. Positive attitude – optimistic, enthusiastic, encouraging, happy, confident.
7. Professionalism – business like, well-dressed, appearance, poised.
8. Responsibility – accountable, reliable, gets the job done, resourceful, self-disciplined, wants to do well, conscientious, common sense.
9. Teamwork – cooperative, gets along with others, agreeable, supportive, helpful, collaborative.
10. Work ethic – hard working, willing to work, loyal, initiative, self-motivated, on time, good attendance.

The emphasis was given on the ability to communicate professionally to read, write, and demonstrate effectively. The skills were laid down like active listening, meeting skills, presentational skills that build up the soft skills.

Every bit that revolve around soft skills and personality traits were explained and how it is relevant in the modern software engineering job profile was explained. The students understood the importance of communication and social skills in a technical profile. The overall experience was enriching and helped the students to think on personality development and other traits related to soft skills.